

E225

Emerging Professional Practice

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A 58-year-old with advanced heart failure, a retired postal worker who loves gardening, is receiving IV diuretics and wants to continue all treatments. He has severe breathlessness and anxiety. The hospital recently opened a new café. Which service fits his needs now?

- A. A palliative care consult alongside his current treatment
- B. Hospice care
- C. No symptom service until his treatments stop
- D. Palliative care only once death is days away

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A patient with metastatic cancer has a prognosis of about three months. She chooses to stop chemotherapy and focus on comfort at home. Which service fits?

- A. Palliative care only, since hospice requires death within days
- B. Hospice care at home
- C. Inpatient hospice only, since hospice must be given in a facility
- D. No service, since she has stopped treatment

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A 30-year-old graphic designer and mother of two has a confirmed autosomal dominant condition; her partner is unaffected. The family recently moved from another state. What is the chance that each of her children inherits the condition?

- A. 25%
- B. 100%
- C. 50%
- D. 50% for the first child, then lower for the next

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Both parents carry one copy of an autosomal recessive variant. What is the chance that each child is a carrier but unaffected?

- A.** 100%
- B.** 25%
- C.** 50%
- D.** 75%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

During a visit at a practice that recently hired two new medical assistants, a nurse learns that a 35-year-old patient's mother and maternal aunt both had breast cancer before age 45. The patient is training for a triathlon. What is the best nursing action?

- A.** Tell her she will definitely develop breast cancer
- B.** Order a BRCA test and explain the results herself
- C.** Reassure her that her active lifestyle offsets the risk
- D.** Document a three-generation family history and refer to genetic counseling

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A patient with a positive BRCA1 result works for a 200-employee software company with an on-site gym. She worries about discrimination. Which protection does GINA give her?

- A.** Her employer and health insurer cannot use the genetic result in hiring, firing, eligibility, or premiums
- B.** All forms of insurance are barred from using the result
- C.** It protects her only after symptoms appear
- D.** A life insurer cannot use the result to deny coverage

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which situation is NOT covered by GINA?

- A.** An employer asks about family medical history when hiring
- B.** A long-term care insurer uses a genetic test result in underwriting
- C.** A group health plan requires a genetic test to enroll
- D.** A health insurer raises premiums based on a genetic test

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A post-operative patient at a hospital with a new pharmacogenomics program has test results showing he is a CYP2D6 poor metabolizer. The program's pharmacist recently presented at a national meeting. Codeine is ordered for pain. What should the nurse anticipate?

- A. Poor pain relief; discuss an alternative analgesic with the prescriber
- B. Double the codeine dose to overcome the gene
- C. Morphine toxicity and oversedation
- D. No change, since genetic results never affect drug response

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A child who is a CYP2D6 ultrarapid metabolizer is given codeine. What is the main risk?

- A. Little or no pain relief
- B. No risk, since genes never matter for dosing
- C. Morphine toxicity with respiratory depression
- D. An allergic reaction

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A hospice patient at home, whose daughter is a schoolteacher, has distressing breathlessness at rest despite oxygen and a bedside fan. The family recently adopted a puppy. Which approach reflects standard palliative practice?

- A. Perform frequent deep suctioning
- B. Give a low-dose opioid as ordered and titrate to relieve breathlessness
- C. Increase IV fluids to ease breathing
- D. Withhold opioids, since they always hasten death

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A nurse with eight years of ICU experience, who recently moved for her spouse's job, earns a national critical care specialty certification. What does the certification do?

- A. It replaces the need for a license in her new state
- B. It is legally required for every ICU nurse
- C. It grants her advanced-practice prescribing authority
- D. It validates her specialty knowledge but does not replace her state license

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A forensic nurse in an ED with a newly remodeled family waiting room cares for an assault patient whose clothing may hold evidence. The patient’s brother is a police officer. How should the clothing be handled?

- A. Hand the clothing to the brother, since he is an officer
- B. Seal all items together in a plastic bag
- C. Wash the clothing before returning it
- D. Place each item in a separate paper bag, seal and label it, and document the chain of custody

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A 58-year-old with advanced heart failure, ~~a retired postal worker who loves gardening~~, is receiving IV diuretics and wants to continue all treatments. He has severe breathlessness and anxiety. ~~The hospital recently opened a new café.~~ Which service fits his needs now?

Target word: service that fits **Decides:** He wants treatment and has symptom burden.

A	Correct	Palliative care can be given with curative or life-prolonging treatment.
B	Confusion set	Hospice fits when the patient chooses comfort-focused care with a limited prognosis; he wants all treatments.
C	Dropped element	Drops the rule that palliative care goes alongside treatment.
D	Absolute language	Palliative care is appropriate at any stage of serious illness.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

A patient with metastatic cancer has a prognosis of about three months. She chooses to stop chemotherapy and focus on comfort at home. Which service fits?

Target word: service that fits **Decides:** Limited prognosis and choice of comfort care.

A	Confusion set	Hospice eligibility is about six months, not days.
B	Correct	A prognosis of six months or less with a comfort focus fits hospice.
C	Adjacent category	Most hospice care is given at home.
D	Inverted operation	Stopping curative treatment is when hospice begins, not when care ends.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A 30-year-old ~~graphic designer and~~ mother of two has a confirmed autosomal dominant condition; her partner is unaffected. ~~The family recently moved from another state.~~ What is the chance that each of her children inherits the condition?

Target word: chance per child **Decides:** Dominant, one affected parent.

A	Confusion set	That is the chance for an affected child when both parents are recessive carriers.
B	Absolute language	Only one of the parent's two copies is passed on.
C	Correct	Each child has a 1 in 2 chance of inheriting the variant.
D	Dropped element	Drops the independence of each pregnancy.

4. Answer C Concept 2 • transfer

Both parents carry one copy of an autosomal recessive variant. What is the chance that each child is a carrier but unaffected?

Target word: carrier chance **Decides:** Two carrier parents.

A	Absolute language	Carrier status is not certain for every child.
B	Confusion set	That is the chance of being affected.
C	Correct	The Punnett square gives 25% affected, 50% carriers, 25% neither.
D	Adjacent category	That is the chance of being unaffected, carriers and non-carriers combined.

5. Answer D Concept 3

During a visit at a practice ~~that recently hired two new medical assistants~~, a nurse learns that a 35-year-old patient's mother and maternal aunt both had breast cancer before age 45. ~~The patient is training for a triathlon.~~ What is the best nursing action?

Target word: best action **Decides:** Early-onset cancer in two close relatives.

A	Absolute language	Family history raises risk; it does not make cancer certain.
B	Adjacent category	Ordering and interpreting genetic tests is beyond the nurse's role here.
C	Camouflage	Fitness does not change inherited risk.
D	Correct	Red-flag history calls for documentation and referral.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A patient with a positive BRCA1 result works for a 200-employee software company ~~with an on-site gym~~. She worries about discrimination. Which protection does GINA give her?

Target word: GINA protection **Decides:** Health insurance and employment.

A	Correct	GINA covers employment and health insurance.
B	Absolute language	Life, disability, and long-term care insurance are not covered.
C	Inverted operation	GINA protects genetic information before disease appears.
D	Confusion set	GINA does not cover life insurance.

7. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

Which situation is NOT covered by GINA?

Target word: gap in GINA **Decides:** Long-term care insurance.

A	Inverted operation	That is prohibited under GINA.
B	Correct	GINA does not reach long-term care insurance.
C	Adjacent category	Requiring genetic testing for enrollment is prohibited.
D	Confusion set	Health insurers are covered.

8. Answer A Concept 5

A post-operative patient at a hospital with a new pharmacogenomics program has test results showing he is a CYP2D6 poor metabolizer. ~~The program's pharmacist recently presented at a national meeting.~~ Codeine is ordered for pain. What should the nurse anticipate?

Target word: expected effect **Decides:** Poor metabolizers convert little codeine to morphine.

A	Correct	Little codeine is converted to active morphine.
B	Dropped element	Drops the problem; more prodrug still converts poorly.
C	Inverted operation	That is the risk for ultrarapid metabolizers.
D	Absolute language	Pharmacogenomics shows they can.

9. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

A child who is a CYP2D6 ultrarapid metabolizer is given codeine. What is the main risk?

Target word: risk **Decides:** Ultrarapid conversion to morphine.

A	Inverted operation	That is the poor-metabolizer effect.
B	Absolute language	This combination is a known safety warning.
C	Correct	Ultrarapid metabolizers make more morphine quickly.
D	Adjacent category	Metabolizer status does not cause allergy.

10. Answer B Concept 6

A hospice patient at home, ~~whose daughter is a schoolteacher~~, has distressing breathlessness at rest despite oxygen and a bedside fan. ~~The family recently adopted a puppy.~~ Which approach reflects standard palliative practice?

Target word: standard approach **Decides:** Refractory dyspnea at end of life.

A	Adjacent category	Deep suctioning is distressing and rarely helps dyspnea.
B	Correct	Opioids are standard for refractory dyspnea, with comfort as the intent.
C	Inverted operation	Extra fluids can worsen congestion and breathlessness.
D	Absolute language	Titrated low doses relieve symptoms without that effect.

11. Answer D Concept 7

A nurse with eight years of ICU experience, ~~who recently moved for her spouse's job~~, earns a national critical care specialty certification. What does the certification do?

Target word: what certification does **Decides:** Voluntary specialty credential.

A	Confusion set	Only a state license gives legal authority to practice.
B	Absolute language	Specialty certification is generally voluntary.
C	Adjacent category	Prescribing requires APRN education and licensure.
D	Correct	Certification is voluntary and separate from licensure.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A forensic nurse in an ED ~~with a newly remodeled family waiting room~~ cares for an assault patient whose clothing may hold evidence. ~~The patient's brother is a police officer.~~ How should the clothing be handled?

Target word: evidence handling **Decides:** Paper, separate, sealed, documented.

A	Camouflage	Handing it to family breaks the chain of custody.
B	Confusion set	Plastic traps moisture and mixing items cross-contaminates.
C	Inverted operation	Washing destroys evidence.
D	Correct	Paper prevents moisture damage; documentation keeps evidence admissible.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	9	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	2	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Palliative care vs. hospice	Palliative care relieves symptoms at any stage and can go alongside curative treatment; hospice is for a prognosis of about six months or less when the patient chooses comfort-focused care.	Thinking palliative care means giving up treatment or is only for the last days.	A seriously ill patient who still wants treatment, or one who chooses to stop it.
2	Inheritance patterns	Autosomal dominant: 50% chance per child from one affected parent; autosomal recessive with two carrier parents: 25% affected, 50% carriers, 25% neither, each pregnancy independent.	Applying recessive odds to a dominant condition or thinking earlier children change later odds.	A family pedigree and a question about each child's chance.
3	Nurse's role in genetics	Nurses gather a three-generation family history, recognize red flags, and refer to genetic counseling; they do not order or interpret complex tests on their own.	Reassuring a patient based on lifestyle, or interpreting genetic results beyond scope.	Several close relatives with early-onset cancer.
4	GINA protections	GINA bars health insurers and employers (15+ employees) from using genetic information; it does not cover life, disability, or long-term care insurance.	Believing GINA covers all insurance.	A patient worried about how a genetic result will be used.
5	Pharmacogenomics	Gene variants change drug metabolism: a CYP2D6 poor metabolizer gets little relief from codeine, while an ultrarapid metabolizer risks morphine toxicity.	Mixing up which variant causes failure and which causes toxicity.	Metabolizer status and a prodrug such as codeine.
6	End-of-life symptom management	For refractory dyspnea at end of life, low-dose opioids titrated to relief are standard; the intent is comfort, and fluids and deep suctioning often add burden.	Withholding opioids from fear that they always hasten death.	Breathlessness at rest in a hospice patient.
7	Licensure vs. certification	A state license gives legal authority to practice; specialty certification is a voluntary credential that validates expertise but does not replace licensure or expand scope.	Thinking certification works as a license or grants advanced prescribing rights.	A nurse earning a specialty credential.
8	Forensic nursing and evidence	Preserve evidence by placing each item in a separate paper bag, sealing and labeling it, and documenting an unbroken chain of custody.	Using plastic bags or handing evidence to family or friends.	An assault patient with clothing that may hold evidence.

Course scope (public description): Emerging Professional Practice presents a variety of professional nursing specialty areas. Students explore various practice specialties, including palliative care, genetics and genomics, and others. The course provides pathways to specialized nursing practice. All prior courses in the sequence for this program serve as prerequisites for this course.